



THE ULTIMATE WORKING HOLIDAY GUIDE TO AUSTRALIA

A **NON BULLSHIT** APPROACH ON HOW TO **SUCCEED** AS A
BACKPACKER IN AUSTRALIA





PROOF OF REAL EXPERIENCE

These Tickets Are My Proof — And Your Blueprint

What you're about to see on the next page are my actual mining and construction certifications — earned during my **FIRST YEAR** in Australia on a Working Holiday Visa.



My Journey: Year One

- ✓ **Started:** Seeding season for canola in Western Australia — learning the ropes on farms
- ✓ **Progressed:** Obtained essential safety tickets and certifications
- ✓ **Achieved:** Mining shutdown work as a multi-skilled operator
- ✓ **Result:** Every ticket on the next page within 12 months



What These Tickets Represent

- ✓ Verification of Competency (VOC) for confined space entry
- ✓ High Risk Work Licences for rigging and scaffolding
- ✓ Heavy Vehicle Driver's License (HR Class)
- ✓ Site-specific inductions for major mining companies
- ✓ Construction induction (White Card)



This Guide Will Save You Costly Mistakes

This is the **ULTIMATE SOLUTION** to navigate the Australian mining, construction, and farming sectors. No bullshit, no wasted time — just the exact steps that worked for me and will work for you.



[See the actual tickets on the next page](#)



Personal information has been redacted for privacy. Certification types, dates, and issuing organizations remain visible as proof.

Certification Card (VOC)

bhpbilliton

LTD

AP # 933286
3672

Nigel's Service Centre
RTO 7042

Assessment in accordance with the
Structure Industry Training Package

Classes: LS LB LE LL

Certificate No:
000732

Issued:
22/03/2013

Rasmussen

Certification

Nickel West

bhpbilliton
resourcing the future

10/12



WorkSafe WA

OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH AND SAFETY

CONSTRUCTION
INDUCTION

WESTERN AUSTRALIA

Card No 572474

LICENCE TO PERFORM
HIGH RISK WORK

WORKSAFE



MSAPMPER20SC Enter confined space
MSAPMPER200C Work in accordance with an issued permit

Issued: 23/08/2012 Expires: 23/08/2017

Classes:
LF RA RB WP

Date of Issue: 28-06-2012

Cert No: 81,499 / 81,506

bhpbilliton
resourcing the future
Nickel West

Emergency

All Sites NKW 94390045 NKS 9093 5745 NMK 9037 8545
'45' NLN 9026 5345 NKC 9027 6245 CLIFFS 9037 8545

RIIOHS204A Work Safely at Heights

Date of Issue: 27/07/2012

Cert No: 83,181 / 83,186



Quick Reference Glossary

KEY TERMS & CAREER PATHWAYS

CAREER PROGRESSION TIERS

Entry-Level Jobs

Starting positions requiring minimal experience — hospitality, retail, cleaning, warehouse work. Perfect foundation for building Australian work history.

Construction Work

Building and civil construction roles requiring White Card certification. Higher pay than entry-level, with clear pathways to specialization.

Mining Labourer

Entry point into mining sector — general duties, cleaning, maintenance support. Gateway role to operator positions with FIFO benefits.

Mining Operators

Heavy equipment operators — haul trucks, loaders, excavators, dozers. VOC tickets required. \$120K-\$180K+ annual earnings potential.

Seasonal Farm Work

Agricultural roles including fruit picking, packing, and farm operations. Essential for visa extensions — counts toward 88-day regional work requirement.

Rigging & Scaffolding

Specialized construction trades involving load lifting, scaffold erection, and structural support. Requires High Risk Work Licence — premium hourly rates.

Trade Careers

Qualified positions — Boilermaker, Fitter, Electrician. Highest demand trades in mining. Requires certification or RPL pathway.

Senior Mining Roles

Supervisory and specialist positions — Shotfirer, Leading Hand, Supervisor. Peak earning tier requiring extensive experience and leadership skills.

CERTIFICATIONS & LICENCES

High Risk Work Licence (HRW)

Government-issued licence for hazardous work — rigging, scaffolding, crane operation, forklift. Required by law for specific tasks.

TAFE Courses

Vocational training institutions offering nationally recognized qualifications. Certificates I-IV, Diplomas. Pathway to trade qualification.

Oil & Gas Offshore

High-paying offshore platform work requiring BOSIET, HUET safety certifications. Premium rates with extended rosters — \$200K+ potential.

RPL (Recognition of Prior Learning)

Fast-track certification pathway converting overseas experience into Australian qualifications. Skip years of study — work experience counts.

Construction Training Fund

WA government subsidy covering training costs for construction workers. Up to 100% rebate on eligible courses — massive savings on tickets.

ESSENTIAL TERMS

FIFO (Fly-In Fly-Out)

Work arrangement with flights, accommodation and meals provided. Work 2 weeks on-site, 1 week off. Zero living expenses while on roster.

White Card

Mandatory construction induction card. Required for all construction sites Australia-wide. Online or in-person course — valid nationally.

VOC (Verification of Competency)

Site-specific assessment proving equipment operation skills. Required before operating machinery. Valid across similar mine sites.

Labour Hire Agency

Recruitment company placing workers at client sites. Your employer on paper — handles payroll, insurance. Gateway to major companies.

Part 1: Before You Start — Essential Foundations

Understanding Australian Working Holiday Visas

Visa Types

Visa Type	Subclass	Eligible Countries
Working Holiday visa	417	UK, Ireland, Canada, Germany, France, and others
Work and Holiday visa	462	USA, Argentina, Chile, Indonesia, Vietnam, and others

Basic Requirements

- Age: 18-30 years (some nationalities up to 35)
- Eligible passport with no dependent children
- Minimum funds: AUD \$5,000
- Must be outside Australia when applying for first visa
- Meet health and character requirements

Application Process

1. Create an ImmiAccount through the Australian Government immigration website
2. Start new visa application and select correct subclass
3. Fill in personal details, passport info, travel history, health and character questions
4. Upload documents (passport copy required; subclass 462 may need proof of education, bank statements, or government support letter)
5. Pay application fee — **AUD \$635**
6. Wait for decision — many approved within minutes or hours

Extending Your Stay:

- **Second visa:** Complete at least 3 months of specified work in approved regional areas
- **Third visa:** Complete 6 months of specified work while on your second visa
- **Total potential stay:** Up to 3 years on Working Holiday visas

Tax File Number (TFN)

When You Can Apply:

- You are in Australia
- You hold a valid visa (417, 462, student, temporary work, etc.)

Apply online through the Australian Government website once you arrive.

Why a Car is Your Best Investment

- Public transport in Australia is limited and unreliable
- Cars hold their value well due to higher usage tolerances
- A car helps you avoid expensive hostel traps (\$300+/week for shared dorms)
- One week in a hostel without working can cost \$2,000+ AUD

Used 4x4 Price Guide (2026)

Budget Range	Vehicle Options
Very Low Budget \$2,000-\$7,000	Older Great Wall 4x4 wagons, Honda CR-V, Mitsubishi ASX or RAV4
Mid Budget \$8,000-\$15,000	Mitsubishi Pajero, Toyota Kluger, Nissan Pathfinder, Navara/Triton utes
Higher Budget \$15,000+	Toyota Hilux, Land Cruiser Prado

Success Story: "I bought an 80-series Landcruiser at 377,000 km for \$11,000 AUD and sold it at 417,000 km for \$14,000 AUD."

Understanding Recruitment Agencies

How They Work:

- Used for construction, mining, and farming
- Agency charges client more than they pay you (margin = profit)
- Example: Agency charges \$70/hr, pays you \$40/hr = \$30/hr profit per worker

 **Key Points:** As a backpacker, you'll mostly work on casual basis with no paid sick days or holiday pay. **Avoid Gumtree jobs** — often cash-in-hand with no insurance.

Mastering the Job Search

"Think of sending your resume like planting a seed. You're in the recruitment agency's system — then you water it by calling when you don't hear back. Call at least once a week. Hearing back can take up to 3 months."

How to Call Recruitment Agencies

1. **Be calm** — don't rush or sound desperate
2. **Start with small talk** — "Hey, how are you going?" (wait for reply)
3. **Be specific** — state your name and the exact job you want
4. **Follow up** — having already sent your resume and following up sets you apart

My Resume

Creating a professional resume is essential for your job search in Australia.

On the following page, you'll find an example that has worked for me.

Feel free to use it as inspiration for creating your own!

Mr. XYZ



WA 6000



0428624951



latourlukas@gmail.com



Skills

- Strong communication skills
- surface mining 4 years & underground 6 years
- working at heights & Confined Space
- familiar with power tools
- IT VOIVO 120 & Atlas COPCO articulated dump truck 3+ years experience - HR unrestricted + Isuzu Tipper - 996 Cat loader - water cart and bobcat 2+ years & Dangerous Goods card
- high pressure waterblasting, Confined space & Working at heights, EWP and Forklift



Work History

2025-08 - Current

Mineral Process Operator

Hancock Iron Ore, Roy Hill

Ensuring safe processing of in-load ore and communicating with control to fault find issues to minimise production loss. Inspecting work area and usage of SAP to ensure preventative maintenance is abided by and scheduled accordingly.

Bobcat and loader work to clear spillage and build up.

2024-08 - 2025-08

Hose Technician - Day Crew Operator - Process Op.

Hays Recruitment, Roy Hill Mine Site

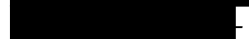
Civil construction work

-driving loaders/ bobcats/ water-carts & tipper trucks

-Hosing and cleaning excess Build up material under conveyors

- operating crushers

 - 0499874232 -Day Crew Supervisor

 - 0427963519 -ILOL coordinator

2024-01 - 2024-05

Service Crew

KCA Site Services For Evolution Mining, Kalgoorlie, WA (Mungari)

Services, vent maintenance and extension plus underground stores stock up.

Pumps install and swap out.

2023-04 - 2024-01

Service Crew Leading Hand

ByrneCut Group, Mount Magnet, WA

leading a small team and fixing air, water poly pipe in the mine. Moving Mono pumps and bringing ground support underground. Moving RCT teleremote huts for bogging operations. Assisting charge up with stopes preparations for firing and isolating services as required. Fan moves for secondary ventilation

2022-05 - 2023-04

All Rounder

About This Resume

This resume was created using MyPerfectResume.com - a popular online resume builder platform that makes it easy to create professional resumes.

MyPerfectResume offers several membership options:

14-Day Premium Access:	\$2.95 trial (then \$23.95/month)
3-Month Full Access:	\$5.95 (no auto-renewal)
1-Year Premium Access:	\$71.40/year (~\$5.95/month)

Premium features include:

- Professional templates optimized for ATS (Applicant Tracking Systems)
- Unlimited downloads in PDF and Word formats
- ResumeCheck™ - AI-powered feedback on your resume
- Cover letter builder
- Interview preparation tools and career resources
- Money-back guarantee within 14 days

You can cancel your subscription anytime!

Visit: www.myp perfectresume.com

Understanding FIFO (Fly-In Fly-Out)

What is FIFO?

FIFO (Fly-In Fly-Out) is a work arrangement common in the Australian mining and resources sector, particularly in remote areas of Western Australia. Workers fly from their home city (usually Perth) to a remote mine site, work a set roster (typically 2 weeks on, 1 week off), then fly home for their break.

How It Works:

-  **Flights:** Employer pays for your flights to and from the mine site
-  **Accommodation:** You stay in purpose-built mining camps on-site — FREE
-  **Meals:** All meals provided in the camp mess — FREE (breakfast, lunch, dinner + snacks)
-  **Transport:** Bus transfers from airport to camp and camp to work site — FREE
-  **Facilities:** Most camps have gym, recreation room, WiFi, laundry facilities



Modern FIFO mining camp accommodation
in the Pilbara, WA



Resort-style FIFO village with quality
amenities



The Savings Advantage of Living on Camp

Why FIFO = Maximum Savings:

While on camp, you have virtually ZERO living expenses. All your money goes straight to savings!

Living Expense	City Living (per month)	FIFO Camp (per month)
Rent/Accommodation	\$1,600 - \$2,500	\$0
Food/Groceries	\$600 - \$1,000	\$0
Utilities (electricity, water, internet)	\$200 - \$400	\$0
Transport/Fuel	\$300 - \$600	\$0
TOTAL MONTHLY SAVINGS	\$2,700 - \$4,500	\$0 expenses!

Real Example: A Mining Labourer earning \$48/hr on a 2:1 roster (84 hours/week while on site):

- Weekly earnings on site: ~\$4,000+ (with overtime)
- Monthly gross (2 weeks on): ~\$8,000 - \$10,000
- Since food & accommodation = FREE, most of this can be saved
- **Potential annual savings: \$80,000 - \$100,000+**

Common FIFO Rosters

Roster Type	Days On	Days Off	Best For

2:1	14 days	7 days	Most common, good balance
8:6	8 days	6 days	Better work-life balance
4:3	4 days	3 days	Drive-in drive-out (DIDO) roles
15:13	15 days	13 days	Senior/specialist roles



TIER 1: Entry-Level Jobs (\$20-\$28/hour)

1.1 Hospitality — Housekeeping & Cleaning

Job Description: Entry-level cleaning and housekeeping roles in hotels, hostels, and resorts.

Expected Pay:
Hourly: \$22-\$28 | Weekly (40 hrs): \$880-\$1,120 | Annual: \$45,000-\$58,000

Requirement	Cost	Notes
None mandatory	\$0	Basic entry-level position
RSA (optional)	\$60-\$150	Beneficial if role includes bar areas

 **Warning:** Avoid businesses offering unpaid trial days — this is illegal in Australia!

1.2 Hospitality — Restaurant & Café Work

Job Description: Food service roles including waiting tables, food preparation assistance, barista work, and kitchen hand duties.

Expected Pay:
Hourly: \$23-\$30 (casual rates) | Weekly (40 hrs): \$920-\$1,200 | Annual: \$48,000-\$62,000

Requirement	Cost	Validity
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RSA (Responsible Service of Alcohol)	\$60-\$150	State-specific, 3-5 years
Food Safety/Food Handler Certificate	\$80-\$150	Varies by state



TIER 2: Seasonal Farm Work (\$25-\$40/hour)

2.1 Tractor Driving / Farm Hand RECOMMENDED

Job Description: Operating tractors and farm machinery for seeding, harvesting, and general farm operations. Modern tractors use GPS auto-steer systems — most driving is in straight lines across vast paddocks at 6 km/hour.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$28-\$40 | Weekly (50-60 hrs): \$1,400-\$2,400 | Seasonal (3-4 months): \$15,000-\$20,000+ saved

Real Example: "I saved around \$17,000 in four months driving a tractor."

Requirement	Cost	Notes
None required	\$0	Farmland is privately owned — no road licenses needed
First Aid Certificate (optional)	\$100-\$150	Some farms prefer this

Seeding Seasons Across Australia:

Crop Type	Season	Regions
Winter crops (wheat, barley, canola, oats)	Autumn: April-June	Southern Australia (WA, SA, VIC, NSW)
Summer crops (cotton, sorghum, maize, rice)	Spring-early summer: Sept-Dec	Northern NSW and QLD

Key Benefits:

-  Food and accommodation usually supplied (minimal expenses)
-  Counts towards 88 days for second visa
-  No experience necessary — training provided
-  No licenses needed on private farmland

2.2 Fruit Picking NOT RECOMMENDED** AVOID — Key Reasons:**

- Paid by piece rate, not hourly — often \$15-\$25/hour effective rate
- "Working hostels" overcharge for accommodation
- Exposure to pesticides causing rashes
- Inconsistent work (sent home when it rains)
- Often exploitative arrangements between hostels and farmers

TIER 3: Construction Work (\$35-\$50/hour)

3.1 Construction Labourer

Job Description: General labouring on construction sites including material handling, site cleanup, basic trades assistance, and operating small equipment.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$35-\$45 | Daily (10-hr shifts): \$350-\$450 | Weekly (50 hrs): \$1,750-\$2,250 | Annual: \$85,000-\$115,000

Real Example: "My advice to French friends was to apply for a construction job outside the city. They both earned \$400 a day for a couple of months."

Required Tickets:

Requirement	Cost	Validity
White Card (Construction Induction)	\$80-\$150	Nationally recognized, no expiry
Standard Driver's License	—	Varies
Manual Handling Certificate	\$80-\$120	Typically 3 years

Optional But Valuable Tickets:

Ticket	Cost	Benefit
Working at Heights	\$200-\$350	Opens more job opportunities
EWP (Elevated Work Platform)	\$250-\$400	Operate scissor lifts, boom lifts

Forklift License (LF)

\$250-\$400

Essential for warehouse/site work

3.2 Traffic Controller

Expected Pay:
Hourly: \$35-\$50 | Daily: \$350-\$500 | Weekly: \$1,750-\$2,500 | Annual: \$80,000-\$120,000

Requirement	Cost	Validity
Traffic Controller Ticket	\$250-\$400	3 years
White Card	\$80-\$150	No expiry
First Aid Certificate	\$100-\$150	3 years

● Rigging & Scaffolding Careers (\$45-\$65/hour)

These mid-tier roles offer excellent pay and are in high demand across mining, construction, and oil & gas sectors.



Industrial rigging work - crane and heavy lifting operations



Scaffolding construction work in Sydney, Australia



Crane and rigging services in mining operations



Construction rigger performing heavy lift operations

🔧 What is Rigging?

Riggers are responsible for safely moving heavy loads using cranes, hoists, and other lifting equipment. They set up and dismantle rigging equipment, select appropriate slings and lifting gear, and direct crane operators during lifts.

Rigging Career Levels:

Level	Description	Pay Range
Dogging	Entry-level: directing crane operators, slinging loads up to 20 tonnes	\$40-\$50/hr
Basic Rigging	Rigging equipment and loads, structural steel erection	\$45-\$55/hr
Intermediate Rigging	Multi-crane lifts, complex load calculations	\$55-\$65/hr
Advanced Rigging	Structural steel erection, moving/positioning machinery over 20 tonnes	\$60-\$75/hr



What is Scaffolding?

Scaffolders erect, alter, and dismantle scaffolding structures that provide temporary work platforms for construction and maintenance activities. It's physically demanding but highly rewarded.

Scaffolding Career Levels:

Level	Description	Pay Range
Basic Scaffolding	Prefabricated modular scaffolds, restricted heights	\$40-\$50/hr
Intermediate Scaffolding	Modular and tube scaffolds, most construction applications	\$50-\$60/hr
Advanced Scaffolding	Hung scaffolds, suspended scaffolds, complex structures	\$55-\$70/hr



Annual Earning Potential:

Intermediate Rigger (FIFO Mining): \$120,000 - \$150,000/year

Advanced Scaffolder (Shutdown Work): \$130,000 - \$160,000/year

Career Progression Path:

1

Start: Trade Assistant / Labourer

Get your White Card, work alongside qualified riggers/scaffolders

2

Get Licensed: Basic/Intermediate HRW Licence

Complete training course + assessment (1-2 weeks)

3

Gain Experience: 6-12 months

Build your resume with site experience, different companies

4

Advanced: Mining FIFO or Shutdown Work

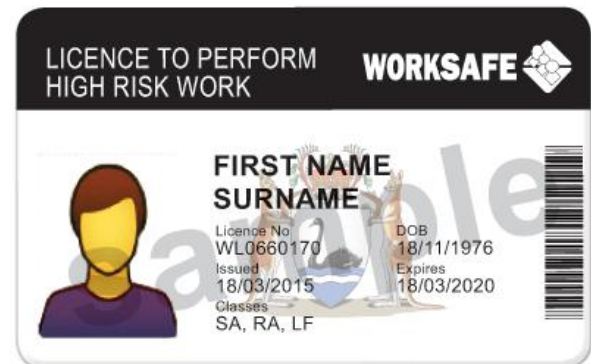
Advanced licence + mining tickets = \$60-\$75/hr

High Risk Work Licences (HRW)

High Risk Work Licences are nationally recognized credentials required by law to operate certain types of equipment or perform specific high-risk activities. They are issued by state WorkSafe authorities after completing approved training and assessment.



Various high risk work activities requiring licences



National High Risk Work Licence Card

Types of High Risk Work Licences

Licence Class	Description	Training Cost	Duration
DG - Dogging	Directing crane operators, slinging loads	\$800-\$1,200	3-5 days
RB - Basic Rigging	Setting up and rigging equipment	\$1,000-\$1,500	5 days
RI - Intermediate Rigging	Multi-crane lifts, structural steel	\$1,200-\$1,800	5-7 days
RA - Advanced Rigging	Heavy machinery, complex lifts	\$1,500-\$2,500	5-7 days

SB - Basic Scaffolding	Modular scaffolds, restricted heights	\$800-\$1,200	3-5 days
SI - Intermediate Scaffolding	Most scaffold types	\$1,000-\$1,500	5 days
SA - Advanced Scaffolding	Suspended and hung scaffolds	\$1,200-\$2,000	5-7 days
LF - Forklift	Operate forklift trucks	\$250-\$400	1-2 days
WP - Boom-type EWP	Boom lifts over 11 metres	\$300-\$500	1-2 days



Getting HRW Licences in Western Australia

Why WA is the Best Place to Get Licensed:

- Higher demand = more training providers = competitive prices
- Mining companies often offer to pay for tickets once employed
- Immediate job opportunities after getting licensed
- Construction Training Fund may reimburse your costs (see below)

Process to Get HRW Licence in WA:

1. **Choose an RTO (Registered Training Organisation)** — Look for TAFE WA, Nara Training, iCollege, etc.
2. **Complete the training course** — Combination of theory and practical assessment
3. **Pass the assessment** — Written test + practical demonstration
4. **Apply to WorkSafe WA** — Submit your Notice of Assessment (NOA)
5. **Receive your licence card** — Valid for 5 years Australia-wide

Popular Training Providers in WA:

Provider	Location	Speciality
TAFE WA (North Metropolitan)	Perth, Joondalup	Full range of HRW courses
Nara Training	Perth, Kalgoorlie	Mining-focused, rigging, scaffolding
iCollege	Perth	Construction tickets
ERGT Australia	Perth	Oil & gas, mining safety



Rope Access Technician Work

Your Gateway to High-Paying Specialized Work in Mining, Construction & Oil/Gas

What is Rope Access?

Rope access is a method of working at height using ropes and specialized equipment to access difficult-to-reach areas. It's widely used in:

- **Mining:** Shutdown maintenance, structural inspections, confined space work
- **Construction:** High-rise building work, bridge inspections, façade maintenance
- **Oil & Gas:** Platform maintenance, flare stack inspections, offshore structures
- **Utilities:** Wind turbine maintenance, telecommunications towers

Pay Rates

Level	Hourly Rate
IRATA Level 1	\$50-\$66/hr
IRATA Level 2	\$60-\$80/hr
IRATA Level 3	\$75-\$95/hr
+ Trade (Fitter/Boilermaker)	\$85-\$110/hr

Night shift +10-15% • Shutdown rates higher

Where to Work

- **WA Pilbara:** \$154,000+/year avg
- **NT:** \$195,000/year avg
- **QLD Mining:** \$122,000+/year
- **Offshore:** Premium rates + allowances

How to Get Your IRATA Rope Access Ticket

- 1 **Prerequisites:** Be 18+, physically fit, no fear of heights. No prior experience needed for Level 1!
- 2 **Training:** 5-day course (30hrs training + 1-day assessment). Covers rope techniques, rescue, rigging.
- 3 **Assessment:** Independent IRATA assessor tests practical skills & theory knowledge.
- 4 **Certification:** Valid for 3 years. Log hours to progress to Level 2 (1,000hrs required).

\$1,650 - \$2,050 AUD

IRATA Level 1 Training Cost • ROI within first week of work!

Where to Train in Australia:

- **Urban Abseiler** (Melbourne) - \$1,999
- **Tasman Rope Access** (SA) - \$1,950
- **Red Rope Access** (Perth, WA) - \$2,050
- **5th Point** (Multiple locations)
- **Anchor Safe** (Sydney)



Career Progression

Level 1 → Work under supervision, entry-level tasks

Level 2 (after 1yr + 1000hrs) → Complex rigging, more independence

Level 3 (after 2yrs + 2000hrs total) → Supervisor, manage teams, top pay

Pro Tip: Combine with a trade (boilermaker, fitter, electrician) for maximum earning potential. Rope access + trade = \$100-\$150/hr in shutdowns!

 TIER 4: Mining Labourer & Trade Assistant

(\$48-\$55/hour)

 **Updated:** This tier has been renamed from "Mining Entry Level" to "Mining Labourer and Trade Assistant" to better reflect the actual roles and career pathway.

4.1 Mining Labourer / Trade Assistant

Job Description: General support work in underground or surface mines including ventilation maintenance, pipe installation (air, water, poly), equipment moving, ground support, and assisting trade qualified workers (boilermakers, fitters, electricians).

Expected Pay:
Hourly: **\$48-\$55/hour** (potential for more on night shift — up to \$60+/hr)
Daily (12-hr shifts): \$576-\$660/day | Roster: 2 weeks on, 1 week off
Annual: **\$110,000-\$140,000**

Required Tickets:

Requirement	Cost	Validity
Standard 11 (Generic Underground Induction)	\$300-\$500	5 years
Working at Heights	\$200-\$350	2-5 years
Confined Space	\$250-\$400	2-5 years
First Aid	\$100-\$150	3 years
Manual Handling	\$80-\$120	3 years

Driver's License (C Class minimum)



Why Western Australia is EASIER to Find Mining Work

134,009

Mining FTE Jobs in WA (2024-25)

47%

of Australia's Total Mining Workforce

11,065

New Workers Needed by 2029

\$200K+

Top Earner Potential

Why WA Dominates Mining Employment:

- 🏆 **Iron Ore Capital:** 65,496 FTE jobs in iron ore alone — massive Pilbara operations
- 🏆 **Gold Rush:** 35,672 FTE jobs in gold mining — Kalgoorlie, Goldfields region
- 📈 **Growth:** WA accounts for 40% of Australia's projected resource workforce growth
- 🛠️ **Skills Shortage:** Critical shortage of workers = easier to get hired
- ✈️ **FIFO Hub:** Perth is the gateway to all major mining regions

⚡ Shutdown Work in Western Australia

What is Shutdown Work? Mining operations periodically shut down for intensive maintenance, repairs, and equipment overhauls. These "shutdowns" require large numbers of workers for short, intense periods — perfect for backpackers!

Why Shutdown Work is GOLD for Working Holiday Makers:

- 💰 **Premium Pay:** Shutdown rates are often 10-20% higher than normal
- 📅 **Flexible:** Short-term contracts (2-6 weeks) — work intensively, then travel
- 🔄 **Year-Round:** Different mines have shutdowns throughout the year
- 🎓 **Experience:** Work alongside experienced tradespeople — learn quickly
- 🛠️ **Variety:** Work on different sites, different equipment, build your resume

Major WA Mining Regions for Shutdown Work:

Region	Main Commodities	Major Employers
Pilbara	Iron Ore	BHP, Rio Tinto, FMG, Roy Hill
Goldfields-Esperance	Gold, Nickel	Northern Star, Evolution, Gold Fields
Mid West	Iron Ore, Gold	Karara Mining, Westgold
South West	Alumina, Lithium	Alcoa, Talison Lithium

How to Find Shutdown Work:

- **Recruitment Agencies:** Programmed, Hays, Chandler Macleod, WorkPac, MAPS Group
- **Job Boards:** SEEK (search "shutdown"), Indeed, Jooble
- **Direct Applications:** FMS Group, Premium Mechanical Group, Centurion
- **Networking:** Once you're in, word of mouth is powerful

 Trade Careers: Boilermaker & Fitter (\$55-\$80/hour)

Trade-qualified workers are the backbone of the mining and construction industries. These roles require formal qualifications but offer exceptional earning potential.

Boilermaker

Job Description: Fabricating, assembling, and repairing metal structures, tanks, pressure vessels, and heavy equipment. Work includes cutting, welding, and fitting metal components.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$55-\$80/hour | Daily (12-hr shifts): \$660-\$960

Annual (FIFO Mining): \$140,000 - \$180,000+

Requirements:

Requirement	How to Get It
Certificate III in Engineering - Fabrication Trade	Apprenticeship (3-4 years) OR RPL
Welding Certifications (AS1796)	TAFE or RTO course
Mine site tickets	Standard 11, Working at Heights, Confined Space

Fitter / Mechanical Fitter

Job Description: Installing, maintaining, and repairing machinery and mechanical equipment. Includes reading technical drawings, using precision measuring tools, and fault diagnosis.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$55-\$75/hour | Daily (12-hr shifts): \$660-\$900

Annual (FIFO Mining): \$130,000 - \$170,000

Requirements:

Requirement	How to Get It
Certificate III in Engineering - Mechanical Trade	Apprenticeship (3-4 years) OR RPL
Hydraulics knowledge	On-the-job or additional courses
Mine site tickets	Standard 11, Working at Heights, Confined Space



TIER 5: Mining — Experienced Operators

(\$65-\$85/hour)

5.1 Machinery Operator (Dump Truck, Loader, Excavator)

Job Description: Operating heavy machinery including articulated dump trucks, loaders (CAT 996 etc.), excavators, and other large equipment on surface or underground mines.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$55-\$75/hour | Daily (12-hr shifts): \$660-\$900

Roster: 2:1 (2 weeks on, 1 week off)

Annual: \$130,000 - \$170,000

Required Tickets:

Requirement	Cost	Notes
HR License (Heavy Rigid)	\$1,500-\$3,000	Required for site driving
Relevant Machinery Ticket (VOCs)	\$400-\$1,000 each	Site-specific assessments
Standard 11 / Site Induction	\$300-\$500	5 years
Working at Heights	\$200-\$350	2-5 years

Common Machinery VOCs:

Equipment	Typical Cost
Articulated Dump Truck (ADT)	\$500-\$1,000

CAT 996 Loader

\$500-\$1,000

Excavator

\$500-\$1,000

Grader

\$500-\$1,000

Water Cart

\$300-\$500

● TIER 6: Mining — Senior & Specialist Roles

(\$85-\$110+/hour)

6.1 Mineral Process Operator

Job Description: Ensuring safe processing of in-load ore, communicating with control room to fault-find issues and minimise production loss. Inspecting work areas, using SAP for preventative maintenance scheduling.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$70-\$90/hour | Daily (12-hr shifts): \$840-\$1,080

Roster: Typically 15 days on, 13 days off

Annual: \$170,000 - \$210,000+

Real Example: "I currently work paying close to \$200K per year on a 15-day-on, 13-day-off roster."

Requirements:

- All Tier 4 & 5 tickets
- Process Plant Induction (site-specific)
- SAP/Maintenance Systems knowledge
- Dangerous Goods License (\$200-\$400)
- HR License (unrestricted)



RPL: Fast-Track to Trade Qualified

What is RPL (Recognition of Prior Learning)?

RPL is a formal assessment process that converts your existing work experience and skills into a nationally recognized qualification — **WITHOUT** years of apprenticeship!

Think of it as: Getting credit for what you already know how to do.

Why RPL is a Game-Changer

The Numbers Speak:

- 🕒 **Time Saved:** Get qualified in weeks, not 3-4 years
- 💰 **Pay Increase:** Trade qualified workers earn 30-50% more than trade assistants
- 📈 **Career Jump:** Go from \$48/hr (trade assistant) to \$65+/hr (tradesperson)
- 📋 **Licence Eligibility:** Many trades require qualifications for contractor licences

How RPL Works:

1. **Free Assessment:** Contact an RTO for initial eligibility check
2. **Evidence Collection:** Gather proof of your experience:
 - Resume and job descriptions
 - Photos/videos of your work
 - References from supervisors
 - Previous certificates and training records

3. **Assessment:** Qualified assessor reviews your evidence against national standards
4. **Gap Training:** If needed, complete short courses to fill any gaps
5. **Qualification Issued:** Receive your nationally recognized Certificate III

Trade Qualifications Available Through RPL:

Qualification	Typical Experience Required	RPL Cost
Cert III Engineering - Fabrication Trade (Boilermaker)	2-3 years	\$2,000-\$4,000
Cert III Engineering - Mechanical Trade (Fitter)	2-3 years	\$2,000-\$4,000
Cert III Carpentry	2-3 years	\$1,500-\$3,500
Cert III Wall and Floor Tiling	2-3 years	\$1,500-\$3,000
Cert III Civil Construction	2-3 years	\$1,500-\$3,500



Pro Tip for Working Holiday Makers:

If you have trade experience from your home country, RPL can convert it to Australian qualifications. This opens doors to much higher-paying roles immediately!

RPL Providers:

- TAFE Queensland — tafeqld.edu.au
- Trade Skills Australia — tradeskillsaustralia.com.au
- Qualify Me! — qualifyme.edu.au
- Noble Training Group — nobletraining.com.au
- Gimbal Group — gimbalgroup.com.au



TAFE Courses & Earning Potential

TAFE (Technical and Further Education) institutions offer practical, industry-focused training that can significantly boost your earning potential in Australia.

Welding Courses — High Demand, High Pay

Welding skills are in critical demand across mining, construction, and manufacturing. Even short courses can dramatically increase your employability and pay rate.

Course	Duration	Cost	Pay Boost
Introduction to Welding	3 days	~\$600	Entry to trade assistant roles
Welding Certification Preparatory (AS1796)	2-10 weeks	\$1,500-\$1,800	+\$5-10/hr for certified welders
TIG/GTAW Certification (Tickets 5, 7)	1-3 weeks	\$765	Premium TIG welding rates
Cert III Engineering Fabrication	12-48 months	\$3,000-\$27,800	Full trade qualification

AS1796 Welding Tickets Explained:

Ticket	Process	Industry Demand
Ticket 1	Manual Metal Arc (MMA) - Plate	High - general fabrication
Ticket 2	MMA - Pipe	Very High - pipeline work
Ticket 3E/3F	Gas Metal Arc (MIG/MAG)	High - production welding

Ticket 5	Gas Tungsten Arc (TIG) - Light gauge	Premium - precision work
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Ticket 7	TIG - Pipe	Premium - process piping
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Earning Potential with Welding Tickets:

- Trade Assistant (no tickets): \$35-45/hr
- Welder with AS1796 Tickets: \$50-65/hr
- Coded Welder (mining/oil & gas): \$65-85/hr
- **Annual difference: \$30,000 - \$50,000+ more per year!**



Construction Industry Training Fund

The Construction Industry Training Board (CITB) offers funding and subsidies for training in the construction sector. **You may be able to get your high risk tickets reimbursed!**

⚠ Note: The CITB operates in South Australia. Other states have similar programs — check your state's training authority.

What Funding is Available?

For Workers (Short Course Training Support):

- Up to **\$3,000 in training subsidies annually**
- Covers CITB-endorsed short courses including:
 - High Risk Work Licences (rigging, scaffolding, dogging)
 - Working at Heights
 - Confined Space
 - EWP Licences
 - Forklift Licence
- Need a CITB number (free to apply)

For Employers (Apprenticeship Training Support):

- Up to **\$7,000** to offset apprentice training costs
- Additional incentives up to **\$20,000** for diversity and retention
- Completion incentive: \$1,000 per apprentice

How to Get Your Tickets Reimbursed:

1. **Get a CITB Number:** Apply free at citb.org.au
2. **Choose Approved Training:** Select a CITB-endorsed course

3. **Provide Your CITB Number:** Give it to the training provider at enrollment

4. **Subsidy Applied:** The subsidy is automatically applied to your course fee

Example Savings:

- Intermediate Rigging course: \$1,500 → After CITB subsidy: ~\$500-800
- Working at Heights + Confined Space: \$600 → After CITB subsidy: ~\$200-300
- **Save hundreds to thousands on essential tickets!**

State Training Authorities:

State	Authority	Website
South Australia	CITB	citb.org.au
Western Australia	Jobs and Skills WA	jobsandskills.wa.gov.au
Queensland	Construction Skills Queensland	csq.org.au
New South Wales	Training Services NSW	training.nsw.gov.au
Victoria	Skills Victoria	skills.vic.gov.au



Investment Summary — Tickets & Licenses

Starter Package (Budget: \$500-\$800)

Best for: Hospitality, Farming, Entry-level Construction

Ticket	Cost	Opens Jobs In
White Card	\$100	All construction sites
RSA	\$80	Hospitality with alcohol service
First Aid	\$150	All industries (preferred)
Manual Handling	\$100	All manual work
Total	~\$430	—

Construction Package (Budget: \$1,500-\$2,500)

Best for: Construction labouring, traffic control, warehouse work

Ticket	Cost
White Card	\$100
Working at Heights	\$300
EWP License	\$350
Forklift License	\$350
Traffic Controller	\$350

First Aid	\$150
Total	~\$1,600

Mining Starter Package (Budget: \$3,000-\$5,000)

Best for: Entry-level mining roles, trade assistant

Ticket	Cost
Standard 11 Induction	\$450
Working at Heights	\$300
Confined Space	\$350
First Aid	\$150
Manual Handling	\$100
HR License	\$2,000
Total	~\$3,350

Rigging/Scaffolding Package (Budget: \$4,000-\$6,000)

Best for: Mid-tier roles in mining and construction

Ticket	Cost
All Mining Starter tickets	\$3,350
Intermediate Rigging OR Scaffolding	\$1,200-\$1,500

Total

~\$4,500-\$5,000



Job Progression Roadmap

1

TIER 1: Hospitality/Cleaning (\$22-\$28/hr)

Investment: \$0-\$150 | Time: Immediate start

2

TIER 2: Seasonal Farm Work (\$28-\$40/hr)

Investment: \$0 | Time: Seasonal (get 88 days here!)

3

TIER 3: Construction (\$35-\$50/hr)

Investment: \$500-\$2,500 | Time: 1-3 months to find work

4

TIER 4: Mining Labourer / Trade Assistant (\$48-\$55/hr)

Investment: \$3,000-\$5,000 | Time: 1-3 months to find work

4b

Rigging & Scaffolding (\$45-\$65/hr)

Investment: \$4,000-\$6,000 | Time: 3-6 months experience

5

Trade Qualified (Boilermaker/Fitter) (\$55-\$80/hr)

Investment: RPL \$2,000-\$4,000 OR Apprenticeship | Time: Varies

6

TIER 5: Mining Operator (\$55-\$75/hr)

Investment: \$6,000-\$10,000 | Time: 6-12 months experience

7

● **TIER 6: Mining Senior/Specialist (\$70-\$90+/hr)**

Investment: Ongoing training | Time: 2-5+ years experience

POTENTIAL: \$170,000 - \$200,000+/year



THE ULTIMATE GOAL



Oil & Gas: The Highest Paying Sector

Higher Than Mining Professionals — This is Your Endgame

\$150K-\$200K

Mining Professional

\$200K-\$350K+

Oil & Gas Offshore



How to Get Oil & Gas Jobs WITHOUT a Trade or Years of Experience

The secret? **Combining the right tickets** creates a pathway that bypasses traditional trade requirements. Here's the strategy:

THE WINNING COMBINATION



Advanced Rigging

+



Scaffolding

+



Rope Access

= Oil & Gas Offshore Entry Ticket



Your Step-by-Step Pathway

1

Get Your Foundation Tickets

White Card, Working at Heights, Confined Space Entry — the basics everyone needs

2

Complete Rigging & Scaffolding Tickets

Basic to Advanced Rigging (RB → RI → RA) + Basic/Intermediate Scaffolding (SB → SI)

3

Get IRATA Rope Access Level 1-2

5-day course, \$2,000. Log 1,000 hours in mining shutdowns to reach Level 2

4

Obtain Offshore-Specific Tickets

BOSIET/HUET (Helicopter Underwater Escape), Offshore Medical, OGUUK Medical

5

Apply to Offshore Rope Access Companies

Vertech, Altrad, Hertel — they need multi-skilled rigger/scaffolders with rope access!

Offshore Rope Access Technician

\$300,000+/year



Why This Combination Works

- **Rigging skills** = You can rig heavy equipment, essential for platform work
- **Scaffolding skills** = You can build access platforms offshore
- **Rope access** = You can work in areas scaffolding can't reach (flare stacks, legs, risers)
- **Combined** = You're a multi-skilled technician who can handle ANY access challenge

Oil & gas companies PAY PREMIUM for this skillset because they don't need multiple specialists!

Timeline: 18-24 months from starting to offshore-ready. Investment: ~\$15,000 in tickets. ROI: First offshore rotation pays it all back!



Final Advice

Australian Work Culture

"Being German myself, I struggled with the idea of having to be perfect. Australia is different — there's a saying that Australia is 'easy going,' and it really is true. Everyone tweaks their resume a bit. Show that you are willing to learn and listen, and do not be arrogant."

The Key to Success

Your interpersonal skills play a bigger role than job experience for lower-tier jobs.

Show willingness to learn, be humble, and demonstrate reliability. This is also true for higher-paying mining jobs.

Avoiding Common Mistakes

1. **Don't get trapped in hostels** — expensive accommodation drains savings fast
2. **Don't travel in large groups** — job searching is more effective alone
3. **Don't limit yourself geographically** — apply Australia-wide
4. **Don't buy the cheapest car** — repairs can cost more than the vehicle
5. **Don't work cash-in-hand jobs** — no insurance, no protection
6. **Don't accept unpaid trials** — it's illegal in Australia

Essential Websites

Resource	URL	Purpose
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Seek	seek.com.au	Job listings
Indeed	au.indeed.com	Job listings
Immigration	immi.homeaffairs.gov.au	Visa applications
TFN Application	ato.gov.au	Tax File Number

This guide represents 13+ years of real experience. Follow the journey, learn from these mistakes, and create your own Australian success story.

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Organization: Jobs arranged from lower-paying to higher-paying positions with clear ticket/license requirements and color-coding system